

Tobias Treppmann

Head of Product Design — shipping AI in production, 15+ years in B2C consumer-scale product

CONTACT

LOCATION

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University

2022 – Present

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland

2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Product/design strategy and collaborative leadership coaching for non-profits, religious organisations, and mission-driven ventures.

PROFILE

Head of Product Design shipping AI product in production at Bibel TV and ChurchDesk.

Designs and prototypes in real code against real APIs — engineering consumes about 70% directly. Berlin-based, German native, English fluent, 15+ years in B2C consumer-scale product.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (Leading German faith-tech media; multi-platform B2C mobile + streaming + connected TV)

Hamburg + Berlin · 2 days/week Hamburg, remote from Berlin

- Designed and shipped a Customer-Support Copilot SKILL in production — handbook loaded as runtime context, not training data
- Scoped the skill's job and defined "good draft" tone, length, and structure with the CS team before tuning the prompt
- Designed escalation as a first-class output for messages that should not be drafted — flag-or-draft routing per inbound message
- Human keeps the send decision, always
- Currently building an AI fundraising pipeline at Bibel TV
- Introduced agentic engineering as a design practice — Figma for layout, then prototype in real code against real Bibel TV APIs
- Engineering consumes about 70% of prototype code directly
- Design-to-prototype cycle compressed from 3–5 days to 1 day
- Spec-to-code ambiguity dropped from 30–50 back-and-forths to 5–10 clarifications
- Owned the design-token API architecture — Git repo, Style Dictionary, automation
- Three-tier hierarchy: global primitives, semantic tokens, component tokens
- Android consuming tokens live, Figma synced via plugin, iOS and web endpoints ready
- Architecture supports server-driven UI
- Lead B2C product design strategy across mobile, web, and connected TV — analysing conversion and usage data, building an experimentation framework
- Runs the "Designing with and for AI" workshop series for stakeholders on AI possibilities and limitations

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk GmbH (European church-management SaaS; six-country GDPR-plus environment) *Copenhagen,*

Denmark · remote from Berlin

- Reframed the funeral-booking project from a single feature into a deeply integrated booking capability
- 70% coordination-time reduction (days to hours), 90% booking acceptance rate through smart filtering, served 20+ cemeteries
- Multi-stakeholder coordination with funeral homes, pastors, cemeteries, and families under GDPR-plus regulation
- Build-vs-buy reasoning — deep integration as the right option, not the cheap one
- Became a core platform feature adopted beyond the initial Hessen region
- Shipped AI-powered alt-text generation in production for company-wide accessibility compliance in a GDPR-plus regulated environment
- Protestant and Catholic data-protection frameworks across Germany, Denmark, UK, Sweden, Norway, and Switzerland
- Delivered SME workflow-automation modules to help parish operations automate remote processes — shared inbox, booking requests, case management
- Conceptualised the case-management ticket system for core church processes
- Dual PM + design role, direct customer collaboration as main project contact, 1 direct report (designer)

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (AI-powered no-code business platform; DACH / UK / US) *Berlin, Germany*

- Designed the AI-powered prompt-to-database onboarding — natural-language prompt generates a database schema, rendered into the real Ninox data-model editor
- Chat panel and direct-manipulation surface side by side — users edit tables and fields directly, continue via chat, or mix both
- Applied the user-agency principle: "show output, allow users to edit"
- Interaction model is the basis for the public Ninox AI beta
- Collaborated directly with the CEO and technical co-founder in stealth — founder-led exploratory project to define the prompt-to-database direction before the product team was involved
- Senior Leadership Team member with parity to product and engineering
- Managed 5 ICs plus 1 design lead
- Coached the design lead through a difficult engineering-lead partnership

- Redesigned the team's collaboration system to include a sidelined engineer — pre-meeting prep, written agendas, structured turn-taking, documented decisions
- Performance calls in both directions: hired 1 designer and 1 writer, let go 1 designer and 1 writer
- Established shared governance of the design system across 4 designers and engineering
- Built navigation, modal, and multi-select searchable dropdown components for the platform

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany — print-on-demand apparel platform serving hundreds of thousands of consumers, research and product UX strategists, 2021 – 2022
redesign, mobile prototype shipped to production · **Product & UX Strategists** · *Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service centre; ITSM / service-to-product transformation)* · Lübeck, Germany · remote
UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA — B2C e-commerce; first mobile revenue stream launched after generating executive buy-in through data · **Product & UX Strategists** · *Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service centre; ITSM / service-to-product transformation)* · Lübeck, Germany · remote
User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA — client-facing UX work at a design consultancy
• Converted individualised, case-by-case support into a standardised, scalable service catalog
• Partnered with the executive team to revamp services; worked with IT on ITSM and service-desk implementation as internal tooling for the Group
Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA — international microfinance non-profit; responsive design and cross-cultural accessibility; HTML / CSS / JS background
• Applied UX, Agile, and product methodologies to service transformation
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Remote — design and front-end development for SME clients
Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Remote — independent web design and front-end development for SME clients
Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Remote — early-career web design
• Led design for a collaborative data-analytics platform serving top US, Canadian, and UK banks and insurers
• 5-year director tenure leading a team of 3 across Germany ↔ NYC (6-hour time-zone gap)
E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany — first e-commerce role
(German catalog e-commerce)
• Designed data-dense interfaces: column charts, big-data pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic
• Solved the sample-based-uncertainty UX challenge for big-data query-builder previews
• Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach hard-to-reach regulated personas in compliance-locked organisations

SKILLS

AI-Era Product Design

Production AI-agent design (CS Copilot SKILL, accessibility AI) · Agent UX (trust, recovery, transparency, escalation as first-class output) · Human-in-the-loop AI workflows · User-agency principles ("show output, allow users to edit") · prompt-to-database interaction patterns · AI-assisted user research synthesis · Workshop leadership for AI adoption (Designing with and for AI series)

Agentic Engineering & Design—Engineering Bridge

Prototyping in real code against real APIs (Claude Code, agentic-engineering practice) · Design tokens delivered as API (Style Dictionary, Git-based sync, three-tier hierarchy) · Server-driven UI architecture · Multi-platform sync (Web / iOS / Android / Figma) · n8n personal workflows · SwiftUI · HTML / CSS / TypeScript

B2C Consumer-Scale Product Leadership

15+ years of B2C consumer-commerce design track · Multi-platform consumer product (iOS / Android / Web / Smart TV / connected TV) · Metric-informed practice (conversion / CSAT / productivity / cost outcome frame) · Print-on-demand apparel e-commerce (Spreadshirt) · US mobile e-commerce checkout (HairDirect) · Multi-country localisation across DACH + Nordics + UK · Experimentation framework design

Design Leadership & Cross-Functional Systems Thinking

Head-of-design roles since 2016 · Senior Leadership Team participation · Founder-stealth engagement (CEO + technical co-founder) · Hiring + performance calls (designers + writers, both directions) · Coaching design leads · Shared-governance design systems · Cross-Atlantic distributed-team leadership · 15+ years of cross-functional partnership (Product / Engineering / Exec / Customer)

Research, Strategy & Stakeholder Education

Continuous research integrated into product cycles · Iterative usertesting.com screening for hard-to-reach regulated personas · Customer-validated AI-feature design · Research-as-strategic-input · Executive-strategy influence through user research · Activation / onboarding / time-to-value design · Workshop series for stakeholder education on AI possibilities and limitations

Responsible AI by Design

GDPR-plus regulated production AI (ChurchDesk alt-text) · Human-in-the-loop send decisions (CS Copilot) · Escalation as first-class output · User-agency principles · Evaluation-as-team-conversation (define good draft with the operator) · Multi-stakeholder coordination under privacy constraints

Languages & Tools

German (native) · English (fluent) · Figma · Style Dictionary · Tokens Studio · Claude Code · Cursor · Zed · n8n · GitHub · macOS